





Marin County Child Care Commission

2025-2030 Strategic Plan

MARIN COUNTY CHILD CARE COMMISSION
LOCAL PLANNING COUNCIL

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Introduction

The Marin Child Care Commission's Strategic Plan for Early Learning and Care fulfills the requirement of the California Education Code, Section 8231 (K) (4), for each Local Planning Council to: "Prepare a comprehensive countywide child care plan designed to mobilize public and private resources to address identified needs."

Equitable Learning Systems

"Equitable learning systems provide access to resources, opportunities, and experiences to children and families that result in positive outcomes that are not associated with children's demographic characteristics. [Systems that] actively and continuously identify and intentionally eliminate manifestations of systemic racism and other forms of oppression."

Meek, S., Iruka, I. U., Allen, R., Yazzie, D. A., Fernandez, V., Catherine, E., McIntosh, K., Gordon, L., Gilliam, W., Hemmeter, M. L., Blevins, D., & Powell, T. (2020). Fourteen priorities to dismantle systemic racism in early care and education. Children's Equity Project. Retrieved from: https://childandfamilysuccess.asu.edu/cep



2025-2030 Strategic Plan

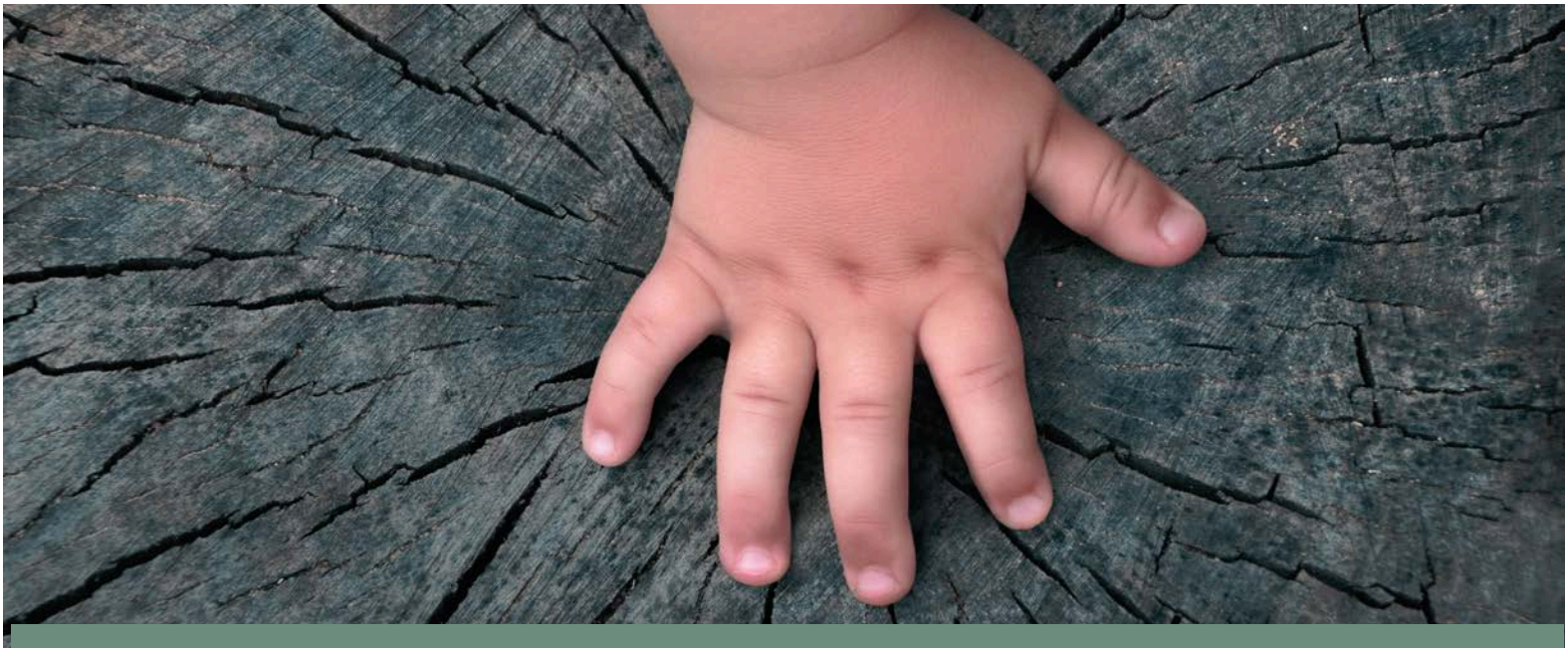
Marin County Child Care Commission

Overview

The primary goal of this Strategic Plan is to engage and unite stakeholders across Marin County in a collaborative effort to advance Early Learning and Care. By maintaining an equity-centered approach, the plan aims to reduce systemic barriers and ensure accessible, high-quality care for all families.

This five-year plan builds on foundational work that began in 2023 with the development of the Marin County Early Learning Roadmap — a collaborative process involving 100 stakeholders, including providers and parents. In 2024, the Marin Child Care Commission completed an updated Needs Assessment, using local data to identify key findings and develop intentional recommendations for Early Learning and Care.

On November 18, 2024, a group of Early Childhood Education leaders in Marin joined commissioners to provide valuable input on the plan's draft goals and strategies, ensuring a shared vision for the future of Early Learning and Care in the county.





The Strategic Plan serves as Marin County's North Star for Early Learning and Care, guiding the path forward with a focus on active engagement in committees and the development of measurable goals with actionable deliverables. However, the success of this plan relies on the commitment and collaboration of all sectors of our community — education, health and welfare, local government, philanthropy, business, and families.

By fostering active participation across these sectors, we can collectively improve children's well-being, strengthen families' ability to thrive, and support a robust local economy.

2023

Marin County Early Learning Road Map

2024

Marin County Needs Assessment

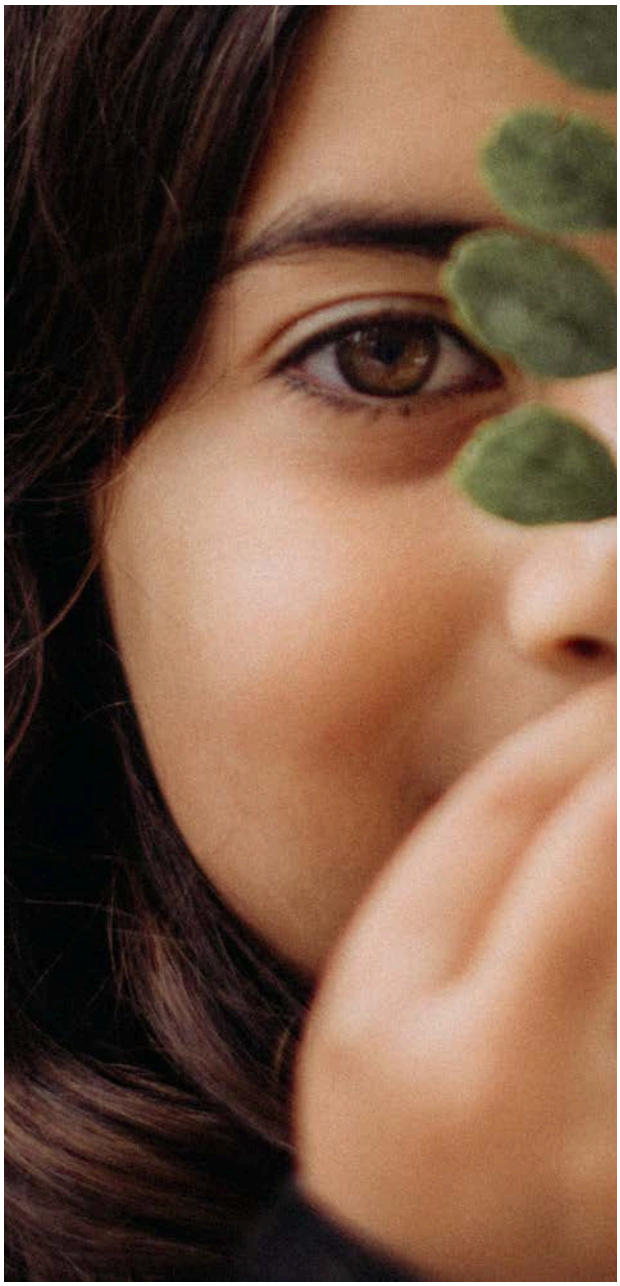
Fall 2024

Marin County Child Care Commission Ad-Hoc Strategic Plan Committee

2025-2030

Marin County Child Care Commission Strategic Plan

Desired Outcomes



Desired Outcome I

Marin County supports high quality early learning and care.

Desired Outcome II

A high-quality early learning and care system is available throughout Marin County.

Desired Outcome III

High quality early care and education programs are staffed by a stable, well-qualified and well-compensated workforce that meets family needs for care.

Desired Outcome IV

Marin County offers equitable and inclusive early learning and care services for all families.

Desired Outcome I

Marin County supports high quality early learning and care.



Baseline

The Children Now 2023 California County Scorecard identified that only 48% of working families were able to find a licensed childcare space for their child. Additionally, the Commission's 2024 Needs Assessment identified an 83% unmet need for infant/toddler care. Increased access to affordable early learning and care should be prioritized in our county as a critical need, as it directly affects a family's well-being, a stable workforce, and an overall well-rounded community.

Goal One

The public will be informed about the importance of supporting early learning and care.

Goal Two

Marin County will prioritize support for access to high-quality, affordable early learning and care for all.

Goal One: The public will be informed about the importance of supporting early learning and care.

Develop Accessible Family Materials: *Create materials informed by focus group feedback to help families navigate mixed-delivery early care and education options.*

Bilingual Public Messaging Campaign: *Launch a bilingual campaign to raise awareness about the critical importance of the early years.*

Promote and Advocate for Early Learning: *Leverage Board of Supervisor meetings, City Council meetings, community, or school district events to showcase the Marin County Child Care Commission's efforts and advocate for the early learning and care field.*

Goal Two: Marin County will prioritize support for access to high-quality, affordable early learning and care for all.

Map Early Learning and Care Funding Streams: *In collaboration, map all Marin County public early learning and care funding streams, assessing whether they have been fully utilized and identifying opportunities for new funding.*

Conduct a Facilities Needs Assessment: *Participate with community stakeholders to complete a Marin County Facilities Needs Assessment and develop recommendations to expand quality childcare capacity based on identified gaps.*

Advocate for Child Care in Housing Developments: *Promote a county-wide policy requiring the inclusion of childcare spaces in new housing development projects.*

Support Public-Private Partnerships for Child Care: *Advocate for partnerships and employer-sponsored benefits to improve the affordability and availability of childcare services.*



Desired Outcome II

A high-quality Early Learning and Care system is available throughout Marin County.



Baseline

The introduction of Transitional Kindergarten (TK) in 2014 changed the traditional model of serving a mixed age group of 3-5-year-olds in a preschool classroom, and what is considered to be developmentally appropriate practice. To compensate for the lack of enrollment, more two-year-olds are now joining preschool classrooms while more 4-year-olds transition on to TK opportunities. Those 4-year-olds are also a part of after-school programs, which have traditionally been for older school-age students.

Goal One

The Marin Child Care Commission will engage the community around the changing landscape of early learning and care, and its impact on quality.

Goal One: The Marin County Child Care Commission will engage the community around the changing landscape of early learning and care, and its impact on quality.

Support Program Adaptation: *Leverage local knowledge to provide resources and training for early learning and care programs, before & after school-age care, and early education TK-3 to adapt effectively to the changing landscape of Universal Pre-Kindergarten (UPK).*

Promote Quality Standards and Local Support Systems: *Develop a Marin-focused document, incorporating feedback, to advocate for high-quality care across all providers. The document should emphasize local systems — such as coaching and training — that support providers in enhancing their understanding and implementation of quality standards.*



> Teachers are people first and teachers second. If our teachers' well-being is not centered and prioritized, either in their own lives or in their work lives, it is going to impact the quality of care accessible to children and families. We can't provide high quality if the quality of the teachers' work environment and the quality of care in their own life is not optimal.
>
> ~Marin Director

Desired Outcome III

High-quality early learning and care programs will be staffed by a stable, well-qualified, and well-compensated workforce that can meet family needs for care.



Baseline

When speaking with program directors, many cite the workforce shortage as a challenge in maintaining services and expanding to serve more children. The Commission's 2024 Needs Assessment shows that 1 in 4 teachers have less than 4 years of experience and with that, an aging workforce is set to retire. A majority of the ECE workforce in Marin cannot afford to live in the county where they work and face challenges with their well-being, often struggling to afford housing, healthcare, food, and other basic needs.

Goal One

In partnership with the community, identify, advocate, and expand upon opportunities to support the workforce.

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Support Workforce Growth and the Quality Counts CA Workforce Pathway Grant: *Collaborate with community partners to remove barriers to professional growth, highlighting the QCC Workforce Pathway Grant, which supports 30 early childhood educators in achieving their Teacher Child Development Permit or AA/BA degree.*

Advocate for Fair Compensation: *Continue to champion state and local funding to ensure fair wages, benefits, and paid time off for the early learning and care workforce.*

Promote Affordable Housing for Educators: *Partner with workforce housing initiatives, including the Marin County Community Development Agency and local school districts, to prioritize affordable housing for early childhood educators.*

Expand the Guaranteed Income Pilot Project: *Advocate for a sustainable revenue stream to advance the Guaranteed Income Pilot (Marin Child Care Council) as a county initiative, incentivizing educators based on experience and educational attainment*

Support Leadership Development: *Convene community partners to develop a mentorship and guidance plan for new program directors.*

Marin Teachers and Assistant Teachers, earn less than the self-sufficiency wage of $37.59/hour for a family of four.

~2024 Early Learning and Care Needs Assessment, pg. 14



Desired Outcome IV

Marin County offers equitable and inclusive early learning and care services for all families in Marin.



Baseline

The 2024 Needs Assessment identified 3,107 children with disabilities and 5,087 multilingual learners. The 2023 Marin Child Care Council Parent Survey cited bullying and lack of language-learning support as top concerns. Furthermore, the COVID-19 pandemic disrupted children's healthy development. While Marin County offers resources for parenting, mental health & disability support, a more collaborative, coordinated system is needed — one that meets families where they are, helps providers individualize care, and removes barriers to accessing services.

Goal One

All entities serving children will be part of a coordinated, integrated countywide system.

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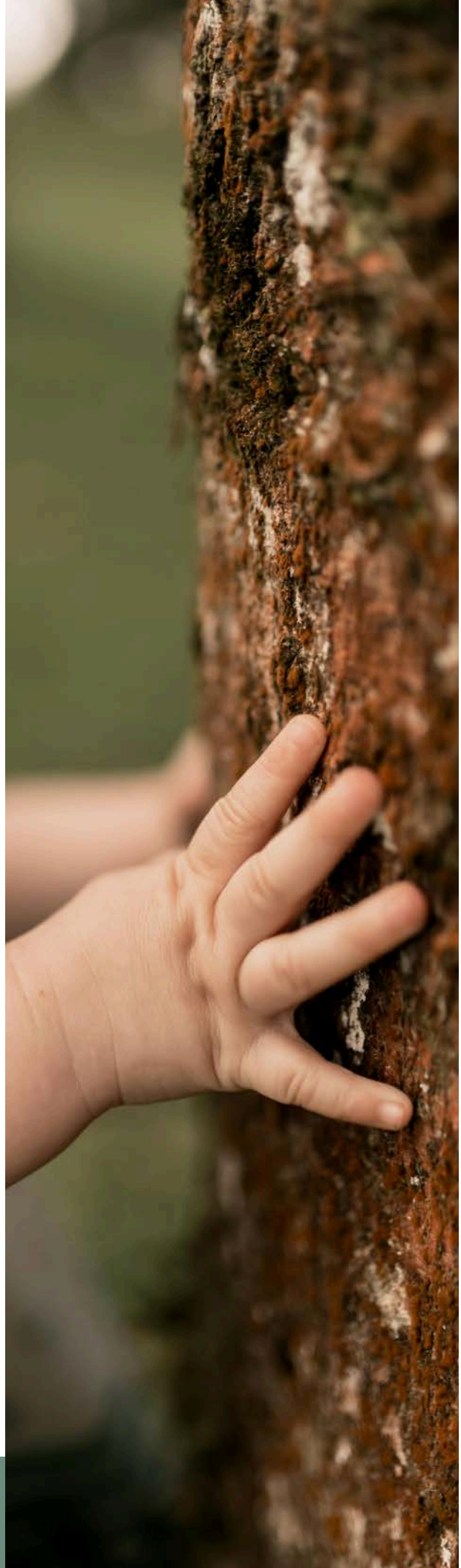
Establish a Leading for Children Network: *Build a network of community partners to engage in Humanity First activities, fostering a shared understanding of a humanity-centered, holistic approach to early learning and care that is inclusive, equitable, and collaborative.*

Promote Inclusive Practices for Children with Disabilities: *Enhance understanding of the early learning and care system for children with suspected or identified disabilities and encourage the adoption of inclusive practices across all providers.*

2024 Early Learning and Care Needs Assessment

"The LPC will strengthen understanding of inclusive practice and the Early Care and Education system for children with identified disabilities and work with community partners around reliable data to help understand access to care."

pg. 22, Commitment and Action



Heartfelt thanks to the sixteen dedicated commissioners for their unwavering support of the 2025-2030 Strategic Plan.

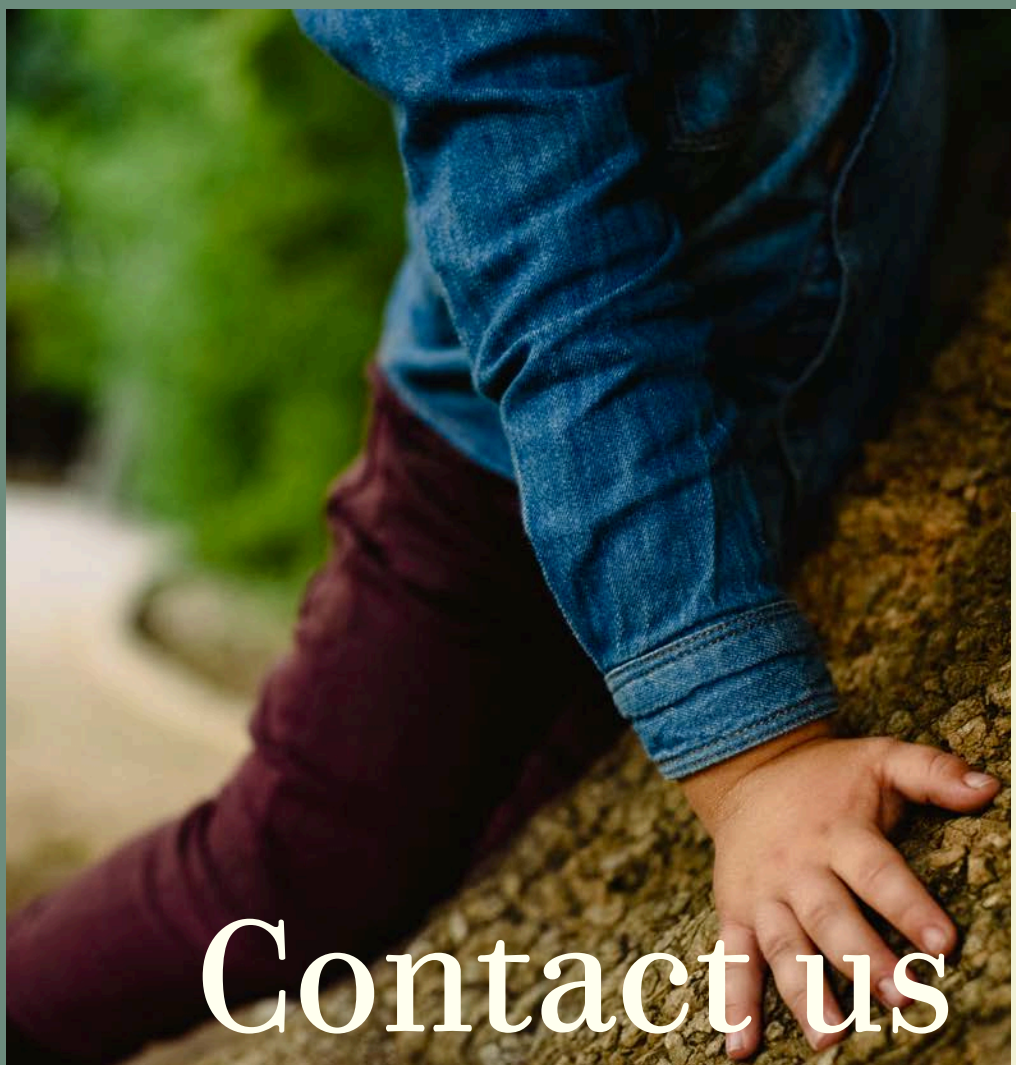
We also deeply appreciate our beloved early learning and care community for staying engaged with our work and actively participating in regular meetings.

We encourage everyone to review the 2025-2030 Strategic Plan alongside the 2024 Needs Assessment.

Both documents are available here:

https://www.marinschools.org/programs-services/services/early-childhood-education/marin-county-child-care-commission





Contact us

MARIN COUNTY CHILD CARE COMMISSION
LOCAL PLANNING COUNCIL

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